

TRACE evaluation report, in full

OR 6205 Deterministic Operations Research · Northeastern University · Spring 2026 · Priscila de Azevedo Drummond, instructor of record

Six students registered, five attended, and all five responded. All five reported attending 80 to 100 percent of sessions. With five respondents no mean here is a robust statistic. I publish the whole report rather than a selection, because a committee that finds the low items on its own has found something I hid.

The written comments below are grouped by question rather than by respondent, so that one student's answers cannot be linked across questions in a class of six. Nothing has been omitted or edited, including the truncation in one comment, which is how the report exported it.

Quantitative items

Course means are computed from the five raw responses on the five-point scale. Department and university means are as reported by TRACE. A dash means TRACE reported no university mean for that item.

Item	Course	Dept.	Univ.
Online course materials were organized to help me navigate week by week	4.80	4.45	4.47
The instructor displayed enthusiasm for the course	4.80	4.55	4.68
The instructor provided sufficient feedback	4.60	4.29	4.41
The instructor facilitated a respectful and inclusive learning environment	4.60	4.54	4.66
Online interactions created a sense of community with classmates	4.50	4.18	4.25
Online interactions with my instructor created a sense of connection	4.50	4.29	4.33
I had the necessary computer skills and technology	4.50	4.61	-
In-class sessions were helpful for learning	4.40	4.34	4.40
The instructor fairly evaluated my performance	4.40	4.46	-
The instructor was available to assist students outside of class	4.40	4.42	-
Required and additional course materials were helpful	4.20	4.48	4.48
The instructor came to class prepared to teach	4.20	4.58	4.66
The instructor clearly communicated ideas and information	4.20	4.36	4.48
Overall rating of teaching effectiveness	4.20	4.41	4.51
The syllabus was accurate and helpful in delineating expectations	4.00	4.56	4.58
The instructor used class time effectively	3.80	4.42	4.51
Out-of-class assignments were helpful for learning	3.80	4.44	4.36
This course was intellectually challenging	3.80	4.48	4.33
I learned a lot in this course	3.80	4.52	4.45

Every response, item by item

Item	Responses
Online course materials were organized to help me navigate through the course week by week.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree, Strongly Agree, Strongly Agree
Online interactions with my instructor created a sense of connection in the virtual classroom.	Strongly Agree, Neutral, N/A, Strongly Agree, Strongly Agree
Online course interactions created a sense of community and connection to my classmates.	Strongly Agree, Agree, N/A, Agree, Strongly Agree
I had the necessary computer skills and technology to successfully complete the course.	Strongly Agree, Agree, N/A, Agree, Strongly Agree
The syllabus was accurate and helpful in delineating expectations and course outcomes.	Strongly Agree, Neutral, Agree, Agree, Agree
Required and additional course materials were helpful in achieving course outcomes.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Neutral, Strongly Agree
In-class sessions were helpful for learning.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
Out-of-class assignments and/or fieldwork were helpful for learning.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Disagree, Agree
This course was intellectually challenging.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Neutral, Neutral
I learned a lot in this course.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Disagree, Agree
The instructor came to class prepared to teach.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Neutral, Strongly Agree
The instructor used class time effectively.	Strongly Agree, Neutral, Neutral, Neutral, Strongly Agree
The instructor clearly communicated ideas and information.	Strongly Agree, Neutral, Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
The instructor provided sufficient feedback.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
The instructor fairly evaluated my performance.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
The instructor was available to assist students outside of class.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree, Neutral, Strongly Agree
The instructor facilitated a respectful and inclusive learning environment.	Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
The instructor displayed enthusiasm for the course.	Strongly Agree, Strongly Agree, Strongly Agree, Agree, Strongly Agree
What is your overall rating of this instructor's teaching effectiveness?	Almost Always Effective, Sometimes Effective, Usually Effective, Usually Effective, Almost Always Effective

Attendance and time on the course, as students reported it

How often did you attend this class both in-person and remotely?

80-100%, 80-100%, 80-100%, 80-100%, 80-100%

The number of hours per week I devoted to this course outside scheduled class meeting times.

8-10, 3-4, 3-4, 5-7, 8-10

Written comments, verbatim

Please comment on your experience of the online course environment in the open-ended text box.

"There is nothing to comment on because it was what I expected"

"good"

"The online course environment was overall good and easy to follow. The materials and lectures were helpful, and I liked that everything was organized in one place. Sometimes it was a bit challenging to stay engaged online, but overall it worked well and supported my learning."

2 of 5 respondents left this question blank or answered "none".

What I could have done to make this course better for myself.

"Definitely manage my time a bit better to put more emphasis on studying some of the confusing topics at hand."

"More reading"

"I could have managed my time a bit better and stayed more consistent with reviewing the material after each class. Starting assignments earlier and practicing more problems would have helped me understand the concepts more deeply."

2 of 5 respondents left this question blank or answered "none".

What were the strengths of this course and/or this instructor?

"I did like that she was very happy to teach this course cause I could tell that she loves this topic so much, and I like that she was able to listen to our feedback to make the course better. Definitely, the group project was the most fun project to do."

"The instructor was very well-prepared and explained concepts clearly. Class time was used effectively, and the feedback on assignments was helpful. They were also approachable and created a respectful and engaging learning environment."

3 of 5 respondents left this question blank or answered "none".

What could the instructor do to make this course better?

"I wish there were more structure to the course because sometimes in class we would be learning about one topic, but then somehow shift very quickly to a different topic that becomes too high-level for me to understand. Also, I guess learning too much of the theoretical information and not enough practical work made me less confident in my knowledge. First of all, I didn't like the textbook. So, while there is good information there, maybe not being as reliant on it would be nice, but I don't know. Reading before class isn't as useful since that textbook was so confusing to begin with, so there could be better information to help with the confusing topics through videos."

"Maybe include a few more real-world examples or practice problems to help reinforce some of the tougher concepts, but overall the course was well-structured."

3 of 5 respondents left this question blank or answered "none".

Please expand on the instructor's strengths and/or areas for improvement in facilitating inclusive learning.

"I think the course was already inclusive, so there's nothing more to add"

"The instructor did a great job creating an inclusive and respectful environment where everyone felt comfortable participating. They were approachable and open to questions. To improve further, encouraging even more student interaction or group discussions could help engage everyone even more."

3 of 5 respondents left this question blank or answered “none”.